

1. The Motherland Calls

The statue beckons fighters to come to the defense of their nation.

The Statue of Unity

597 ft (182 m)
Gujarat, India; 2018
The world's tallest statue, depicting India's first Deputy Prime Minister.

Spring Temple Buddha

420 ft (128 m)
Lushan, China; 2002
Named after the nearby Tianrui hot spring.

Religious statues

Many religious movements use statues to inspire belief and to aid worship.



Guanyin, Hainan, China

11. Buddha

381 ft (116 m); Monywa, Myanmar; 2008
Depicts the Buddha standing. World's third-tallest statue.

12. Guanyin

354 ft (108 m); Sanya, Hainan, China; 2005
Represents the goddess Guanyin blessing the world.

13. Virgin of Peace

154 ft (47 m) Trujillo, Venezuela; 1983
The Virgin Mary, mother of Jesus, is shown holding a dove of peace in her hand.

14. Shiva

143 ft (44 m); Chitapol, Kathmandu, Nepal; 2012
Hindu god Shiva stands with a trident in his left hand. His right hand offers a blessing.

15. Murugan

141 ft (43 m); Batu Caves, Gombak, Malaysia; 2006
Statue stands by a cave shrine to the Hindu god Murugan.

Historical statues

Nations often use statues to celebrate famous people from their past. If a controversial figure has been chosen, this can lead to the statue being defaced or even toppled by the public.

6. Yan Di and Huang Di

348 ft (106 m); Zhengzhou, China; 2007
Shows the heads of two legendary kings regarded as the early founders of the Chinese nation.

7. Peter the Great

315 ft (96 m); Moscow, Russia; 1997
Erected to celebrate 300 years of the Russian Navy, which Tsar Peter I founded.

8. Guan Yu

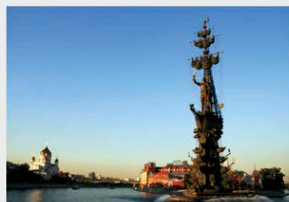
200 ft (61 m); Yucheng, Shanxi, China; 2010
Statue of the general Guan Yu (160–219), later deified as Chinese god of war, at his birthplace.

9. José Maria Morelos

131 ft (40 m); Janitzio, Michoacán, Mexico; 1934
Mexico's rebel leader in the War of Independence (1810–21), fist clenched.

10. Genghis Khan

131 ft (40 m); Tsonjin Boldog, Mongolia; 2007
This statue depicts the famous Mongol leader (ruled 1206–1227) mounted on a horse.



Peter the Great